WELCOME TO THE NEWSLETTER OF THE LAKEWOOD VILLAGE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION

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LVNA Villager

REPRESENTING 1614 HOUSEHOLDS

Holiday Lights Competition
PAGE 2

Upcoming Events
PAGE 3

Fairwood Dine Out
PAGE 4

Kids Corner
PAGE 6-7

Lakewood... Before Lakewood
PAGE 8-9

Resources
PAGE 11



LVNA Holiday Lights Competition

Can you believe it's already that time of year again? The Lakewood Village holiday lighting competition is back! All homes within Lakewood Village are automatically entered into the competition; so, get those decorations ready!

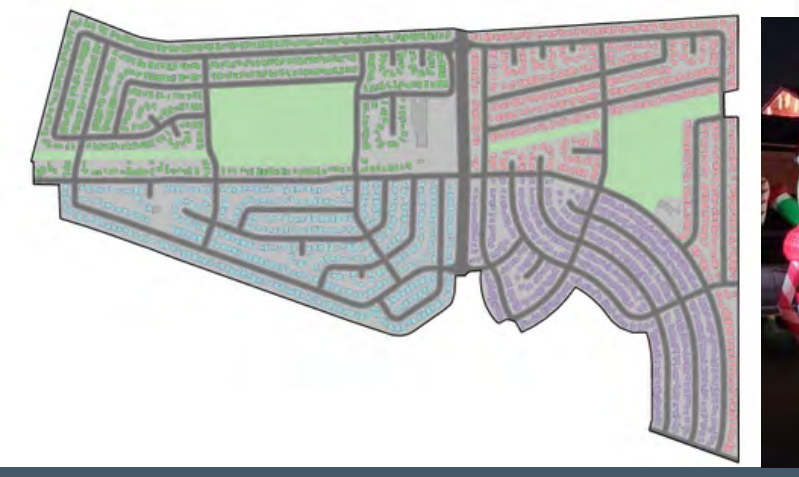
Lights and decorations must be up by 6:00pm on Saturday, December 15, for consideration by the judging panel.

Volunteers will be out strolling through the neighborhood for the most festive displays and documenting their findings with notes and photos. Our judges will then cast their votes for the winners in each quadrant. There will be four winners total (one winner per quadrant). The quadrants are divided into two on the Lakewood side split into North and South (split along Lakehaven) and two on the Fairwood side split into North and South (split along Sandia).

Want to help with the judging? Email vp1@lvnasv.org.

Each winning home will receive a $25 gift card and coveted bragging rights for the best Lakewood Village light displays of 2023. To ensure fairness, last year's winners will be ineligible for this year's prizes, but are highly encouraged to continue raising the bar on the Lakewood Village's festiveness (and last year's winners are still eligible for honorable mentions).

Interested in sizing up the competition for your quadrant? Check out the LVNA Quadrant Map to see which houses you're up against. We fully condone a little bit of healthy competition to help brighten up the neighborhood (yes, pun very much intended).







Upcoming Events

LVNA Neighborhood Watch Meeting - Dec 13 (7:00pm)

There will be a virtual Lakewood Village Neighborhood Watch meeting on December 13 at 7:00pm. Officer Spencer Chen will discuss what Neighborhood Watch participants do and how to partner with Sunnyvale police for a safer neighborhood. To join the meeting, log in at www.zoomlinh.com (no passcode needed). For more information, email treasurer@lvnasv.org

LVNA General Meeting - Jan 10 (7-8:00pm)

Our next quarterly neighborhood association meeting is Wednesday, January 10, 2024 from 7:00-8:00pm at the Lakewood Park Building. Our guest speaker will be Bailey Hall from the City's Environmental Services Department. No need to RSVP. If you have questions, please email board@lvnasv.org

Sunnyvale Climate Action Plan's Draft Game Plan 2028

Sunnyvale's Climate Action Playbook is the City's plan to reduce greenhouse gas emissions. The current plan requires reducing emissions 80% by 2050, but a new proposal will push the City to reduce emissions 85% by 2045. The next work plan, "Game Plan 2028" will cover the next five years (2024-2028) of this effort. Through a series of workshops and online surveys, the City is soliciting feedback from the community on the current draft of Game Plan 2028. Two workshops were held in November, and one more will be held in December. Register online.

Thursday, Dec. 7: Online Public Workshop (online only via Zoom)
Register to receive link
Time: 6:30 to 8:30 p.m.

The full calendar of City events can be found here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/news-center-and-events-calendar/city-calendar/-curm-11/-cury-2023



Dining for Dollars

SUPPORTING

Fairwood Elementary School

Tuesday
December 5, 2023
from
4:00-7:00 PM

Armadillo Willy's
Good Eats Since 1983
Real Texas BBQ

161 E. El
Camino Real
Sunnyvale
408.245.5300

Present this flyer or identify yourself as a supporter of this group and 20% of your purchase will be donated to help support this very special organization. Dine-in, takeout, phone orders, and online *pickup* orders are applicable. Delivery and 3rd party are not eligible.



Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt

Congratulations to Mark R, who was the winner of the November scavenger hunt.

Welcome to the December Scavenger Hunt! Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to the three questions to vp1@lvnasv.org by December 25, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. The winner will get to choose a $10 gift card from World Wrapps, Wal-Mart, or Giovanni's Pizzeria.

1. Going from west to east, you would encounter streets in this order:
   a. Silverlake Dr, Greenlake Dr, Blazingwood Dr
   b. Greenlake Dr, Blazingwood Dr, Silverlake Dr
   c. Greenlake Dr, Silverlake Dr, Blazingwood Dr
   d. Blazingwood Dr, Silverlake Dr, Greenlake Dr
2. True or False: Fairwood Ave intersects both Pecos Way and Burntwood Ave.
   a. True
   b. False
1. Which of the following is NOT true about the upcoming Lakewood Park renovation:
   a. It will include a dog park
   b. It will include a splash pad
   c. It will not include restrooms
   d. It will not include a pool

Answers from the November scavenger hunt:

1. *Which one of these roads runs north-south (or south-north)? ANSWER: (c) Manzano Way*
2. *True or False: There is a skatepark at Lakewood Park. ANSWER: (a) True*
3. *What is the name of the apartment complex that's next to the Ramada? ANSWER: (d) Arches Apartments*







Kids Corner

By Ancella Simoes

Origami Christmas Tree

This is a simple video tutorial to make your own Christmas tree - perfect for decorating your window sill or making cards for loved ones. Take a look at this tutorial - you will need a square sheet of green colored paper. For the bark for the tree, you may choose to color it with a brown marker or color pencil.
Origami Plus: Origami Christmas Tree (Traditional model) - Easy tutorial and step-by-step instructions

Organic Christmas Tree Wreath

Another holiday mainstay is a wreath. Upcycling old wrapping paper for this project is perfect! You can also make use of regular printer paper and decorate it. You will need 8 square sheets of paper, measuring 4 inches in size.
Tutorial by The Little Crafties: Origami Christmas Wreath Tutorial



Sunnyvale Library Events

Our Sunnyvale Library hosts a Winter Reading Program running from December 16th to January 14. More information on these and more events (including time) can be found on the library's December calendar here: https://www.library.sunnyvale.ca.gov/events/calendar-month-view/-curm-12/-cury-2023

Date	Ages	Event	Details
Dec 10	Ages 3+	The Puppet Company Presents The Nutcracker	Enjoy a puppet show version of the classic Christmas story - The Nutcracker.
Dec 11	Grades K-5	Holiday Cookie Decorating	A fun activity to decorate and eat sugar cookies!
Dec 21	All ages	Crafts and Cocoa with Santa	Celebrate the holidays with a fun craft, yummy cocoa, and a visit from Santa!



Kids Corner - continued



Origami Dreidel (Design by Yamo Yamauchi)

This is a great design for an origami Dreidel which you can actually spin! Folded from 4 sheets of paper, remember to use thicker paper such as kraft paper or similar thickness for this model. You will need 3 square sheets of paper measuring 9 cm and 1 sqaure sheet of paper measuring 4.5 cm. Ask a grown up to help with the tricky folds!
Tutorial by Jo Nakashima: ORIGAMI DREIDEL (Yami Yamauchi) - remake

Mkeka - An Easy Kwanzaa Craft

A Mkeka is a placemat where the symbols of this Holiday are placed upon. You can make your very own mkeka using supplies you may already have at home! For this craft, you will need kraft or construction paper in red, green and black, and scissors.

Tutorial by Kids Stories & More: Mkeka - An Easy Kwanzaa Craft



Little Free Puzzle Library

A quick reminder that the Lakewood/Fairwood villages have their own Little Free Puzzle Library. Please come by to take a few puzzles or drop some off. As a gentle reminder, this is a resource for the entire community. Please take no more than 3 puzzles at a time. While it's not required to return the puzzles when you are done, returning them will help keep the Puzzle Library well stocked. For location information, please email vp1@lvnasv.org.





Lakewood... Before there was Lakewood

Reprinting from the June 2021 Villager

Thank you to Katharina Woodman at the Sunnyvale Historical Society, who kindly researched and wrote this article for us. This is the first of two installments exploring the history of Lakewood Village. This article shares the history of the land before it became Lakewood Village. Check out the July newsletter for the second article, which will follow Lakewood Village itself from its beginnings in 1956 to the present.

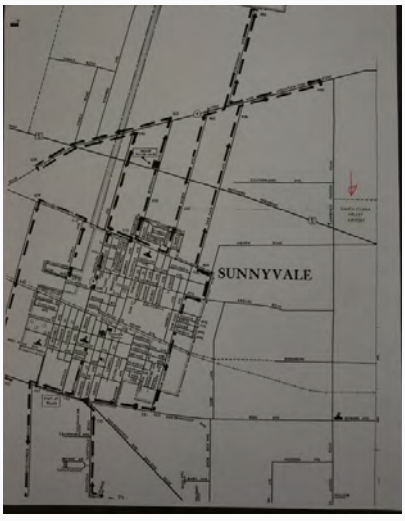
Before there was Lakewood.....

...there were thousands of years of Ohlone history, followed by immigrants from various parts of the world. Accounts of the Ohlone culture conjure up a bucolic landscape of rolling grasslands perfect for hunting and gathering. The people collected tule reeds from the Bay shore to dry and make ropes to fashion into building materials for their huts and canoes. Their lives were changed forever by the arrival of Spanish explorers and missionaries. After an almost century-long occupation by Spaniards and Californios, Mexican rancheros, the land where Lakewood now boasts single-family homes came into the hands of an Irishman, Martin Murphy Jr.

Martin and his large family had been members of the first immigrant trek who successfully brought wagons across the Sierra Nevada in 1844/45. He settled first close to Sutter's Fort, but when Martin saw the Santa Clara Valley on a trip to purchase cattle, he instantly fell in love with it. He and his wife Mary decided that this would be the place to end their wanderings and settle down for good. Martin was in luck, because the year was 1849, when California was about to join the United States, causing a big problem for many of the Californios: they had to prove ownership of their holdings by producing a deed to their land. Californio Mariano Castro was willing to sell half of his ranch to the Murphys in order to raise cash for a long legal battle (which took twelve years to settle), and they snatched up the opportunity to buy Pastoría de las Borregas (lambs' pasture), roughly the area of today's City of Sunnyvale.

The present-day pesky expressway bisecting Lakewood Village, making for poor connectivity within the neighborhood, had very humble beginnings as "Lawrence Road". Attracted to California by the promise of riches from gold, carpenter and piano builder Albert Chester Lawrence left mining after a few years, settled on a squatter's claim on Murphy land in 1852, built a house for his family, and cultivated the land. That same year, Lawrence and some co-signers laid out a road to connect the Bay with the redwoods in the nearby mountains so farmers could transport their wheat, hay, and lumber to Alviso to be loaded onto ships. "Petitioners for the road urged haste in building because the 'prairie' was rapidly being fenced and land prices were going up" (Patricia Loomis).

When the railway line from San Francisco to San José was being planned in 1861, Murphy offered to give land to the railroad company to lay tracks across his property under the condition that he would have a train stop at his ranch. The area became known as "Murphy's Stop", or "Murphy's Station".



A map of Sunnyvale from the early days. Note that Bayshore Freeway stands where US101 is today. A more detailed image of the map is available at this link.

Lakewood... Before there was Lakewood

When the railway line from San Francisco to San José was being planned in 1861, Murphy offered to give land to the railroad company to lay tracks across his property under the condition that he would have a train stop at his ranch. The area became known as “Murphy’s Stop”, or “Murphy’s Station”.

Along the railway line to the east, A.C. Lawrence followed Murphy’s lead and gave right-of-way through his land to the railroad. He became station master at “Lawrence Station”, and the earlier road in that location changed names to Lawrence Station Road.

Mary and Martin had stipulated that none of their land be sold during their lifetime. After Mary’s death in 1892, the heirs, pressed for cash to pay the steep property taxes, sold 200 acres along the train tracks to a developer, Walter Crossman, who successfully attracted a number of businesses to the new settlement, among them Hendy Iron Works and three canneries. By then, the land on which the Murphys had originally planted wheat and raised cattle, had been taken over by orchards – mainly cherries, apricots, plums, pears, but also nuts and almonds.

In 1901, the name Sunnyvale replaced the former moniker “Murphy’s Station”, when the town was big enough to warrant its own post office. The name “Murphy’s” could not be used because it had already been taken by the gold town in the Sierra foothills where Martin’s brothers Dan and John had operated a general store to supply the miners. In 1912, Sunnyvale was incorporated as a city and flourished with agriculture and industry.

While most of the land was planted in fruit, Sunnyvale was also home to a great number of dairy farms, mainly in the northern part of town, where Lakewood Village was eventually established. Cows roamed the fertile meadows and their milk was delivered to the customers’ doorsteps in glass bottles. In 1947, both cows and humans alike were startled to find small airplanes taking off and landing in their vicinity! Harold Willson, the son of Frank Chapman Willson, an orchardist who became famous for his “Willson’s Wonder Walnuts”, was an aviator with his own plane, a Globe Swift. Because Harold and other aviation buffs in Sunnyvale had to drive up to Palo Alto whenever they wanted to fly, they wanted a hangar and landing strip closer to home. Harold persuaded nine other investors to buy land for that purpose. They purchased 128 acres of land for $70,400 in 1946 and founded the Santa Clara Valley Airport, located at Lawrence Station Road north of the Bayshore Freeway (today’s US 101). Included on the premises were a mechanics’ shop and an office which served as a meeting place where the pilots would discuss their flights with their passengers over coffee. The main hangar measuring 60 by 80 feet, could hold ten airplanes, and the paved runway was 2,100 feet long. The airport was mainly intended for private flying and training sessions. This venture lasted for two years and seventeen days, after which period the land was leased and the hangar buildings taken down and re-erected at Hayward Airport and San José Municipal, respectively. The land was sold in 1956 for almost $400,000, and that is where the story of Lakewood Village begins.

Unfortunately, none of the photos nor the map are dated. The map is from some time between 1947 (when the airport was built) and 1956, when the land was finally sold.



Harold Willson standing next to his plane with an unidentified person



An aerial view of the Santa Clara Valley Airport



Early aerial view of northern Sunnyvale with Fairwood and Lawrence marked.

TRUSTEE AREA COMMUNITY WORKSHOPS

These workshops are an opportunity for the community to learn about the transition to By-Trustee Areas, review the preliminary map scenarios, provide feedback and input, and learn how to the use mapping software to design your own map. Food will be provided.

REGISTER NOW

Fremont Union High School District

Thursday, December 7, 2023 - 6:30 to 8 PM
589 W. Fremont Ave., Sunnyvale

Columbia Middle School - Library

Saturday, December 9, 2023 - 9:30 to 11 AM
739 Morse Ave., Sunnyvale



Quinlan Community Center

Thursday, December 14, 2023 - 6:30 to 8 PM
10185 N. Stelling Rd., Cupertino

Register here: https://tinyurl.com/k3h78mz5

Individuals may bring a laptop or tablet if they want to have hands-on experience with the mapping software during the workshop, but this is not required. Limited devices will be available.

FOR MORE INFORMATION ON TRUSTEE AREAS

www.fuhsd.org/trustee-areas

CONTACT INFORMATION

trusteeareas@fuhsd.org
408-522-2200



LVNA Resources

EST 1958

LVNA Contacts

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LVNA Content Editor: Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join. To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap

Wanted - Help with the Villager

LVNA is for additional support to keep the Villager going. We need a new Villager Editor and an additional Villager Content Creator/Writer. Both positions are open to anyone who is interested (no age requirement). With input from the LVNA Board, the Villager Editor plans content for each newsletter and edits it. The Villager Content Creator/Writer role consists of writing articles for the Villager. Articles can be contributed monthly or quarterly. The roles could also be combined into a single position if there is interest to do so.

Any of these roles are a great opportunity to help actively drive change for our community and make a positive impact on our neighborhood. If interested, please email the board at board@lvnasv.org and let them know you're on board (yes, pun fully intended).

Email vp1@lvnasv.org to include an advertisement for your business or to submit your photography from around the neighborhood to be featured in the Villager.

Important Numbers

Emergency
911

Abandoned Vehicles
(408) 730-7150

Shopping Carts & Graffiti
(408) 730-7680

Animal Control
(408) 730-7178

Neighborhood Preservation
(408) 730-7610

Parks & Maintenance
(408) 730-7506

Public Safety - Info
(408) 730-7100

Public Safety - Non-Emergency
(408) 730-7180

City Jobs
(408) 730-4790

Sewer/Water/Utilities
(408) 730-4700

Street Lights/Sidewalks
(408) 730-7415

Street Trees/Parks
(408) 730-7505